

Vocabulary and Exercises: Convincing People in Sales

Advanced C2-Level Vocabulary for Persuasion in Sales Contexts

Estimated Time: 15 Minutes

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Prepared by: Ahsan Hussain Khan, AHK Academy

1. Introduction

This lesson focuses on advanced (C2-level) vocabulary for persuasion in sales contexts. You will learn 20 words, their pronunciation, simple synonyms, examples, and usage. Then, complete quick exercises to practice.

Instructions: Spend 5 minutes reviewing the vocabulary, 5 minutes on Exercise 1, and 5 minutes on Exercise 2.

2. Vocabulary List

Below are 20 advanced words related to convincing or influencing people, especially in sales. Each includes pronunciation (in IPA), simple synonyms, an example sentence, and its usage in sales.

1. Elicit /ɪlɪt/

- Simple Synonyms: Draw out, bring forth.
- Example: The salesperson elicited a positive response by asking open-ended questions.
- Usage in Sales: Use to elicit customer needs during a conversation to tailor your pitch.

2. Coerce /kɔːs/

- Simple Synonyms: Force, pressure.
- Example: He coerced the client into signing by emphasizing the limited-time offer.
- Usage in Sales: Avoid coercing buyers; it can lead to buyer's remorse—instead, use gentle persuasion.

3. Induce /ɪndjuːs/

- Simple Synonyms: Cause, prompt.
- Example: The discount induced the customer to make an immediate purchase.
- Usage in Sales: Induce action by offering incentives like bonuses or trials.

4. Sway /sweɪ/

- Simple Synonyms: Influence, convince.
- Example: Her testimonials swayed the hesitant buyer toward the product.
- Usage in Sales: Sway opinions with social proof, like reviews or case studies.

5. Allure /əˈluːr/

- Simple Synonyms: Attract, tempt.
- Example: The luxurious packaging allured shoppers to the premium brand.
- Usage in Sales: Allure customers with appealing visuals or exclusive features.

6. Beguile /bIgaIl/
 - Simple Synonyms: Charm, deceive (in a light way).
 - Example: The charismatic rep beguiled the audience with stories of success.
 - Usage in Sales: Beguile prospects with engaging narratives to build rapport.
7. Captivate /kæptIveIt/
 - Simple Synonyms: Fascinate, hold attention.
 - Example: The demo captivated the group, leading to multiple orders.
 - Usage in Sales: Captivate during presentations with interactive elements.
8. Compel /kmpEl/
 - Simple Synonyms: Urge, drive.
 - Example: The urgency of the deal compelled her to buy right away.
 - Usage in Sales: Compel decisions with time-sensitive promotions.
9. Entice /IntaIs/
 - Simple Synonyms: Lure, tempt.
 - Example: Free samples enticed visitors to explore the full product line.
 - Usage in Sales: Entice leads with giveaways to draw them into the funnel.
10. Influence /InflUns/
 - Simple Synonyms: Affect, guide.
 - Example: Positive reviews influenced his choice of supplier.
 - Usage in Sales: Influence buyers through authority, like expert endorsements.
11. Manipulate /mnIpjUleIt/
 - Simple Synonyms: Control, handle cleverly.
 - Example: She manipulated the negotiation to favor her terms.
 - Usage in Sales: Ethically manipulate conversations by steering toward benefits (avoid unethical tactics).
12. Persuade /prswelD/
 - Simple Synonyms: Convince, talk into.
 - Example: He persuaded the team to upgrade their software subscription.
 - Usage in Sales: Persuade with logical arguments and emotional appeals.
13. Prevail upon /prIveIl pn/
 - Simple Synonyms: Urge successfully, convince.
 - Example: She prevailed upon the client to extend the contract.

- Usage in Sales: Prevail upon indecisive customers with follow-up calls.

14. Seduce /sɪdʒʊs/

- Simple Synonyms: Tempt, charm into.
- Example: The elegant design seduced buyers into choosing the higher-end model.
- Usage in Sales: Seduce with aspirational branding to upsell.

15. Woo /wu/

- Simple Synonyms: Court, attract.
- Example: The company wooed top clients with personalized perks.
- Usage in Sales: Woo potential partners through relationship-building events.

16. Inveigle /ɪnveɪɡl/

- Simple Synonyms: Trick into, persuade slyly.
- Example: He inveigled the investor with promises of quick returns.
- Usage in Sales: Inveigle cautiously—use to gently guide toward a close.

17. Cajole /kəˈdʒoʊl/

- Simple Synonyms: Coax, sweet-talk.
- Example: She cajoled the reluctant buyer with flattery and facts.
- Usage in Sales: Cajole objections away with humor and empathy.

18. Wheedle /wiːdl/

- Simple Synonyms: Coax, beg charmingly.
- Example: The rep wheedled extra budget approval from the manager.
- Usage in Sales: Wheedle during negotiations for better deals.

19. Blandish /blændɪʃ/

- Simple Synonyms: Flatter, coax.
- Example: He blandished the customer with compliments on their taste.
- Usage in Sales: Blandish to build trust and soften resistance.

20. Coax /koʊks/

- Simple Synonyms: Gently persuade, encourage.
- Example: She coaxed the team into trying the new service.
- Usage in Sales: Coax hesitant prospects with risk-free trials.

3. Exercises

3.1 Exercise 1: Matching (5 Minutes)

Match each vocabulary word (1–10) to its simplest synonym. Write the letter next to the number.

1. Elicit
2. Coerce
3. Induce
4. Sway
5. Allure
6. Beguile
7. Captivate
8. Compel
9. Entice
10. Influence

Options: A. Force B. Attract C. Charm D. Urge E. Lure F. Affect G. Draw out
H. Cause I. Influence J. Fascinate

3.2 Exercise 2: Fill in the Blanks (5 Minutes)

Use words from the vocabulary list (11–20) to complete the sentences. Use each word once.

11. The salesperson tried to _____ the client with exclusive VIP access.
12. Don't _____ buyers; build genuine relationships instead.
13. She managed to _____ upon the hesitant team to sign up for the webinar.
14. Use storytelling to _____ your audience during pitches.
15. He _____ the discount to get the deal closed.
16. With gentle words, she _____ the customer into adding extras.
17. The rep _____ praise to soften the negotiation.
18. Try to _____ objections by addressing concerns early.
19. Always _____ with facts and empathy in sales calls.
20. She _____ the lead into a demo with a free consultation offer.